

Table 1: Summary statistics.

This table reports the start date, mean, volatility/standard deviation, skewness and kurtosis for the 55 instruments from their earliest availability. The arithmetic monthly mean returns and standard deviation are both annualised. The detailed data sources are described in Section A of the Online Appendix. As seen in the table, the average monthly returns and volatilities vary quite dramatically across different asset classes.

Asset	Start Date	Annual Mean	Annual Volatility	Skewness	Kurtosis
Commodity futures					
Aluminum	1987-06-02	0.026	0.206	0.132	3.867
Brent	1988-06-24	0.100	0.322	0.454	6.156
Cocoa	1970-01-06	0.081	0.327	0.517	3.975
Coffee	1972-08-17	0.091	0.387	1.090	6.338
Copper	1986-04-02	0.082	0.254	0.110	6.607
Corn	1970-01-06	0.064	0.279	0.410	6.213
Cotton	1970-01-06	0.067	0.297	-0.402	7.419
Gas Oil	1989-07-04	0.104	0.331	0.327	4.867
Gold	1975-01-03	0.066	0.196	0.528	6.707
Heating Oil	1980-01-03	0.084	0.356	0.739	8.227
Lean Hogs	1986-04-02	0.073	0.343	0.191	4.519
Live Cattle	1970-01-06	0.057	0.197	0.037	4.078
Natural Gas	1990-04-04	0.165	0.544	0.494	4.044
Nickel	1987-01-06	0.135	0.418	2.531	20.747
Platinum	1984-01-27	0.039	0.229	0.024	7.909
RBOB	1986-08-22	0.130	0.401	0.707	6.006
Silver	1970-01-06	0.104	0.342	1.353	14.729
Soy Meal	1970-01-06	0.088	0.349	1.913	18.949
Soy Oil	1970-01-06	0.074	0.316	0.897	7.382
Soybeans	1970-01-06	0.071	0.291	0.776	9.254
Sugar	1970-01-06	0.123	0.459	1.659	9.671
Wheat	1970-01-06	0.069	0.291	0.592	5.091
WTI	1983-03-31	0.068	0.329	0.422	5.980
Zinc	1989-01-05	0.035	0.244	-0.053	4.887
Currency futures					
AUD	1971-01-06	-0.002	0.110	-0.725	7.182
CAD	1971-01-06	-0.003	0.065	-0.289	8.058
EUR	1971-01-06	-0.002	0.111	-0.183	3.821
JPY	1971-01-06	0.022	0.114	0.480	5.175
NZD	1971-01-06	-0.002	0.120	-0.403	9.870
NOK	1971-01-06	0.009	0.104	0.081	4.571
SEK	1971-01-06	0.025	0.110	0.927	7.294
CHF	1971-01-06	0.016	0.124	0.076	4.301
GBP	1971-01-06	-0.005	0.101	-0.078	5.153
Equity index futures					
SPI	1970-01-06	0.075	0.193	-0.670	10.241
CAC	1970-01-06	0.079	0.203	-0.114	3.911
DAX	1970-01-06	0.087	0.197	-0.506	5.119
FTSE/MIB	1970-01-06	0.074	0.238	0.409	4.169
TOPIX	1970-01-06	0.066	0.187	-0.172	4.279
AEX	1970-01-06	0.074	0.192	-0.556	5.474
IBEX	1970-01-06	0.070	0.209	-0.092	4.544
FTSE	1970-01-06	0.086	0.197	1.172	17.689
S&P 500	1970-01-06	0.080	0.154	-0.463	4.773
Bond futures					
AUS3	1986-01-02	0.011	0.063	-3.391	37.454
AUS10	1986-01-02	0.009	0.048	-4.970	85.085
EURO2	1986-01-02	0.018	0.081	0.213	8.129
EURO5	1986-01-02	0.023	0.073	-0.002	9.478
EURO10	1986-01-02	0.037	0.078	0.235	5.771
EURO30	1986-01-02	0.037	0.124	-0.672	10.224
CA10	1986-01-02	0.023	0.074	-1.347	13.016
JP10	1985-10-22	0.016	0.054	-0.323	8.357
UK10	1982-11-19	0.010	0.091	-1.687	16.211
US2	1986-01-02	0.004	0.028	-0.053	8.363
US5	1986-01-02	0.008	0.047	-0.668	8.046
US10	1982-05-04	0.020	0.074	-0.305	6.311
US30	1977-08-23	0.019	0.118	-0.048	6.306